

Wayve

Embodied AI / Autonomous Driving · London, UK · Private (~\$8.6B; \$1.2B Series D, Feb 2026)

Wayve - Britain's embodied-AI leader for autonomous driving, valued at \$8.6B after a \$1.2B Series D in February 2026 - is the rare brand whose 'future of mobility' story is native to Formula E, with no autonomy or mobility-AI brand anywhere on the grid.

74

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

FE

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Nissan Formula E

ACTION HORIZON

8-12 WKS

THE CASE

Wayve is the UK's embodied-AI champion for autonomous driving: founded in 2017 by CEO Alex Kendall, it raised a \$1.2B Series D in February 2026 (about \$1.5B including Uber's milestone tranche) at an \$8.6B valuation, backed by SoftBank, Nvidia, Microsoft and Uber alongside automakers Mercedes-Benz, Nissan and Stellantis. It is launching a London Uber robotaxi service in 2026 and supervised-autonomy software in consumer vehicles from 2027. For Formula E - the championship that exists to tell the future-of-electric-mobility story - an autonomous-mobility-AI brand is an unusually native fit, and no autonomy or mobility-AI brand holds an FE partnership. The honest counterweight: Wayve's customers are automakers, reached through industry channels, so a motorsport play is a brand, innovation-narrative and recruiting halo (it is in a fierce AI talent war), not a B2B-pipeline channel.

WHY NOW

Wayve is freshly capitalized (\$1.2B in Feb 2026) and scaling fast into commercial robotaxi launches - a brand-building inflection where a young, recruiting-hungry AI company invests in identity and talent visibility. The autonomy/mobility lane on the FE grid is empty, so moving now secures a clean, native category before a peer notices it.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

~\$8.6B

Valuation (Series D, 25 Feb 2026)

\$1.2B

Series D raise (~\$1.5B incl. Uber milestone tranche)

Alex Kendall

Co-founder & CEO (since 2017)

auto + big tech

Strategic investors incl. automakers Mercedes-Benz, Nissan, Stellantis (+ Nvidia, Microsoft, Uber, SoftBank)

2026-27 rollout

London Uber robotaxi launch 2026; consumer supervised-autonomy from 2027

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE FE GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

Nissan	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Andretti	CROWDED	TWG AI, Quest Global, NAGASE
Porsche	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Jaguar TCS Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A British embodied-AI champion (\$8.6B, fresh off a \$1.2B Series D) whose autonomous-mobility story maps onto Formula E's 'future of mobility' identity better than almost any brand - and no autonomy/mobility-AI brand is on the grid. The honest caveat: its buyers are automakers, so this is a brand/innovation/recruiting halo, not a B2B-pipeline play.

FUNDING EVENT

NEVER ENTERED

CATEGORY WHITESPACE

DISCOVERY: SELF

WHY NISSAN FORMULA E

Nissan Formula E fits on the merits: a works EV manufacturer with no autonomy or mobility-AI partner on its car, so Wayve owns the lane, and the deepest engineering counterpart on the grid for a real technical workstream. There is also a relationship door - Nissan is one of the automakers (with Mercedes-Benz and Stellantis) that invested in Wayve's Feb 2026 Series D - which warms an introduction and offers a ready 'showcase our autonomy bet' narrative. Treat that as a door-opener, not a near-done deal: a strategic road-car investment and an FE marketing spend are separate decisions on separate budgets - which is precisely the gap 1440 would broker. Envision Racing (a sustainability-first independent with a greenfield roster) is the clean-slate alternative.

VALUE TO NISSAN FORMULA E — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A (developing) - real substance on three fronts, not signage. (1) TECHNICAL: Wayve's core competencies - embodied AI, large-scale simulation, real-time perception-and-control and sensor/data fusion - map onto a works team's hardest problems: race-strategy optimisation under uncertainty, energy- and battery-management modelling across a stint, and high-fidelity simulation. A defined joint workstream (Wayve engineers paired with Nissan's strategy and simulation group) gives genuine performance value, with room to deepen over the term. (2) A SHOWCASE NARRATIVE: Nissan is among Wayve's Series-D automaker investors, so a visible partnership could turn that strategic bet into a public tech-leadership story - positioning Nissan at the front of the autonomy-plus-EV future its brand is staking out (a warm intro and a ready angle, not a deal the investment makes automatic). (3) STORY & TALENT: a shared future-of-mobility content platform plus a co-branded recruiting programme in a brutal autonomy talent market. Nissan gains performance capability, a differentiated innovation narrative and recruiting pull; Wayve gains a works-manufacturer global stage and deepens a strategic relationship.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Mobility AI Partner tier on Nissan Formula E (Envision Racing as a clean-independent alternative), minimum three years, ~\$3-5M/yr, with category exclusivity for autonomy/mobility-AI, a defined joint technical workstream (Wayve AI/simulation applied to race strategy and energy modelling), and a content/innovation-narrative programme aimed at talent and enterprise audiences.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Alex Kendall

CO-FOUNDER & CEO, WAYVE - VERIFIED

Alex Kendall co-founded Wayve in 2017 (Cambridge PhD, a pioneer of end-to-end 'AV2.0' learned driving) and serves as CEO, owning strategy, brand and the company's scale-up agenda - the right and direct entry point for a marquee brand decision. Co-decision-makers: the CFO/ commercial leadership steering the post-Series-D scale-up.

OPENING ANGLE

"Alex, Formula E exists to tell the future-of-mobility story - and Wayve is that story, yet no autonomy brand is on the grid. A British embodied-AI leader owning the lane, with a recruiting and innovation stage in front of the right audience. 25 minutes?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 16 / 20 Fresh \$1.2B Series D at an \$8.6B valuation (25 Feb 2026) and a 2026 London robotaxi launch - peak capital and brand momentum now.	CAPACITY 18 / 20 \$8.6B valuation, ~\$1.5B raised in Feb 2026 (with Uber's milestone tranche); an FE deal is immaterial.	BRAND FIT 15 / 20 Autonomous-mobility AI is an unusually clean fit for Formula E's future-of-mobility identity, and a British brand suits the championship - though as MODE B the value is a halo, not in-car tech.	URGENCY 12 / 20 Fresh capital and a recruiting land-grab in autonomy, but no dated external forcing function.	OPS FIT 13 / 20 MODE A (developing): not Wayve's product in the car, but its AI, simulation and data-science capabilities applied to the team's race-strategy, energy-modelling and simulation work - a real, deepenable technical workstream.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

BUYERS ARE AUTOMAKERS, NOT THE PADDOCK Wayve sells AI to OEMs, so F1/FE hospitality doesn't reach its pipeline - the sponsorship logic is halo/recruiting, not B2B leads. **Counter:** Lead with brand-establishment, the talent war (autonomy recruiting is brutal) and the mobility-native narrative; keep it a relationship-and-halo play, modest and scalable.

AUTOMAKER-INVESTOR ENTANGLEMENT Nissan, Mercedes and Stellantis are investors, which could complicate an independent team choice. **Counter:** Recommend the conflict-free independent (Envision); if the team prefers, the Nissan investor relationship is a ready-made warm path instead.

SOURCES

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